Flag 13 of 18: Developer Who Queried the AI Model

Rogue Synthesis scenario · Cymbal Investments · Google SecOps SIEM

Question

What developer username initiated a request to the model used by our AI threat?

Answer

alex.chen

Evidence

The GTIG AI Threat Tracker report describes PROMPTFLUX calling the Gemini model `gemini-1.5-flash-latest` with a hard-coded API key. The search for AI-service traffic returned three users:

- **alex.chen** (Cloud Engineering and DevOps, IP `10.240.12.80`): `POST` to `generativelanguage.googleapis.com/v1beta/models/gemini-1.5-flash-latest:generateContent`, with an API key in the URL, at 20:23:56Z. The user agent was `node-fetch/3.3.2`, a Node.js program and not a browser.
- **sarah.jenkins**: Vertex AI (`us-central1-aiplatform`), normal developer use.
- **marcus.vance**: `gemini.google.com` in a browser, normal use.

Only alex.chen matches the report: same model name, hard-coded key, scripted client.

How it was found

Window: Oct 1 to Oct 20, 2026.

```
principal.namespace = "Cymbal"
AND metadata.event_type = "NETWORK_HTTP"
AND (target.hostname = /generativelanguage\.googleapis\.com|huggingface\.co/
nocase
     OR target.url = /generativelanguage|gemini-1\.5|huggingface|Qwen/
nocase)
```

Lesson

The report names the artifacts to hunt for. Several users may call the same service, so separate normal use from malware by the user agent and the request details.

Next pivot

Look backward from the API call for what alex.chen downloaded just before it.